Of Bike Thieves and Vigilantes

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/38271655.

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General Audiences

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No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Bow (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra)

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by catrasredemption (dimensionhoppingrose)

Summary

Standing on the doorstep was an admittedly attractive women with dark skin, wild brown hair pulled back in a ponytail, and two different colored eyes one sky blue, the other a deep, golden amber. Both of them look entirely pissed off.

"Hey, you had the bike in your front yard, right?" she asked before Adora could even say hello.

"What? Oh, yeah."

"Did you put it away somewhere?"

Adora stared at her, absolutely bewildered. "Um, no, it was stolen a few weeks ago—"

"I knew it!" The woman whirled on her heel to call to her friend standing on the sidewalk. "I told you, Scorpia! Let's go!"

They both sprinted away without another word. Adora stared after them, bewildered, and then closed the door, going back to the couch. That had been *weird*.

It was even weirder when the doorbell rang *again* half an hour later. She stood, curious now, and went to open it. And there was the woman again, with her friend, and—

"Is that my bike?"

Notes

I swear on my life this is based on a true story. More about that at the end

See the end of the work for more notes

In retrospect, it was a little Adora's fault.

She didn't take too much of the blame because people were jerks, but Bow and Glimmer *had* told her she needed something more secure than a cinder block to keep her new bike safe. But who would go through the trouble of hauling a cinder block away *with* the bike?

Someone, apparently, because she opened the door one morning for her daily ride, and the bike was gone.

It was stupid.

"We'll save up to get you a new one," Glimmer assured her while Bow made breakfast. Adora was resting her head on the table, trying not to cry. It was a *stupid* thing to cry over. These things happened. It wasn't her fault people were terrible. It was a *nice* bike, and expensive. She'd gotten a great deal on it. Why did people have to suck so much?

She was home alone one night while Glimmer and Bow were out on a date, moping on the couch, watching a movie, when someone rang the doorbell. She stared at it for a moment, debating not answering, but it rang again. Finally she dragged herself up, going to open the door. Standing on the doorstep was an admittedly attractive women with dark skin, wild brown hair pulled back in a ponytail, and two different colored eyes – one sky blue, the other a deep, golden amber. Both of them look entirely pissed off.

"Hey, you had the bike in your front yard, right?" she asked before Adora could even say hello.

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"Is that my bike?"

"*Yes*." There was venom in the woman's voice. "We were out running, and I saw this guy riding it, and I recognized the bike — 'cause, you know, it kind of stands out with the three wheels and all — and we stopped him and asked if it was his, and he said yes, and I knew he was lying, motherfucker. I told him if I came here and there was no bike in the yard, I'd come back and kill him."

"*But*"…

"She didn't kill him, don't worry," the woman's friend said cheerfully.

"Got the bike back, though." She sounded proud as she gestured to the bike. "Might wanna get better security for it. That particular idiot probably won't come back for it, but there are plenty of others out there. God I hate that shit. Anyway, see you later."

Adora just stood there, stunned, not even thinking to ask for names until both women were long gone.

Glimmer *cackled*. Bow, the voice of reason in the group, was trying not to laugh, but failing. "I mean, as long as they didn't hurt anyone "—

"I hope she knocked his teeth out!" Glimmer said through gasps for air. "Oh my *god*."

She doubled over. Bow patted her back, chuckling. "That was pretty nice of her to get your bike, though. Did you get her name?"

Adora blushed, shoulders hunching. "No. Everything happened so fast, and then she was just kind of gone."

"Well, she must live in the neighborhood. And you have your bike." Bow grinned. "We could go for a ride this weekend."

"Yeah." Adora perked up slightly. "Yeah, we can."

Adora was practically giddy as she pedaled down the street. This was the only kind of bike she'd been able to ride since being discharged – various chronic pains made regular bikes almost impossible, and the recumbent bike was amazing. It was like being free.

Bow rode along side her, looking back every now and again and shooting her a grin. This had been their morning ritual for a long time, and he'd missed it as well.

"I think people just moved into that house," Bow said, nodding to a house as they pulled to a stop. There was a young, skinny blonde woman in the front yard, kneeling in front of a garden and planting some flowers. Bow cupped his hands to call out to her. "Hey!"

The woman looked back in surprise, then smiled and waved. "Hello! Nice day for a ride, isn't it?"

"We're enjoying it." Bow leaned on his handlebars, grinning. "This is probably a little weird, but you don't happen to know a couple of bike vigilantes, do you?"

"Bike vigilantes?" the woman repeated, then laughed. "Hang on."

She went inside, calling a couple names. The large, white-haired woman came out first, looking cheerful. "Oh, hey! It's not too messed up, is it? We tried to make sure it was still working, but neither of us know much about bikes."

"It's perfect," Adora said honestly. "I really can't thank you enough."

"Ah, well." The woman chuckled. "Wildcat did most of the work, I just stood behind her and looked scary. I can't actually punch, ya know. But I'm big."

The smaller of the two with the different colored eyes stumbled out of the house, yawning. "Scorpia I *swear* if you tell me you found another leaf that looks like Entrapta—" She paused when she saw Adora, blinking a few times. "Oh, hey."

Oh. She was cute. Her hair was messy, her clothes baggy and hanging off her lithe form. She smothered a yawn, then dug the palm of her heel into one eye. The blonde woman finally came back out, beaming.

"They're looking for the bike vigilantes," she informed them, kissing the bigger of the two on the cheek.

"Aaaawww. Hey, do you think—"

"We are *not* re-naming ourselves the biki vigilantes."

"Catra's too attached to super pal trio at this point," the blonde teased, heading back to her garden.

"I am *not*!"

Bow looked at Adora, trying not to laugh when he saw the starstruck look in her eyes. Not entirely surprisingly—she had a Type, and the big woman fit it almost to a T.

"I'm Bow," he introduced himself. "And this is Adora."

"Scorpia." The big woman indicated herself. "Catra." The grumbling shorter woman. "And Perfuma." The woman at the garden. "Nice to meet you."

"You too." Bow shot Adora another look, lightly kicking the side of her bike. She shook her head, re-focusing.

"I just wanted to say thank you. For real, I mean. I didn't get a chance to last night, you guys kind of disappeared."

Catra rubbed the back of her neck, shrugging. "Eh, no big deal. Stealing someone's bike is such an asshole move, especially an expensive one."

"I really wasn't sure about harassing the guy," Scorpia admitted. "Catra was pretty adamant that it was your bike, though."

"We run by the house every day." Catra kicked her bare foot lightly against the cement. "I just saw it a lot."

Scorpia chuckled. "Guess I should pay better attention. But we're really glad everything worked out. Hey, do you guys like board games?"

"Love 'em."

"Perfect. We're having a game night next Friday, wanna come?"

"We never actually play board games," Catra added. "It usually ends up being Uno because Mermista constantly wants revenge for the last time someone beat her."

"Sounds great," Bow said. He exchanged contact info with Scorpia, and they left.

Glimmer was just waking up when they got home. "Found them!" Bow said triumphantly. "Adora already has a crush."

"I do *not*!" Adora protested, cheeks red. Glimmer snorted, rolling her eyes.

"One of 'em must have muscles."

"Oh yeah. *Really* tall. And friendly."

Adora hurried upstairs to the shower. She didn't want to have this conversation, and she certainly didn't want to argue that Scorpia wasn't the one who had caught her eye.

They did end up going to board game night, because Glimmer wanted to meet them now too, and they'd been invited, after all. The living room was a bit crowded, and it took a moment to introduce everyone – there was the competitive Mermista with her boyfriend, Sea Hawk, a magenta-haired woman sitting on the floor with her laptop named Entrapta, and two women who introduced themselves as Catra's moms.

"You are *not*," Catra informed them, glaring half-heartedly. "They are *not* my moms."

"Do you see how mean she is?" one of them said dramatically, hand over heart. The other patted her shoulder.

"There, there, Netty. She's just going through a phase."

Catra rolled her eyes, shaking her head. "Netossa, Spinerella." She pointed at them as she said their names. "They're *two bears* older than me and already act like old ladies."

"Speaking of which, let's get this game thing on the road." Netossa clapped her hands together. "We need to be home by eight for bedtime."

"I need to stop inviting you to things," Catra muttered, grabbing the deck of Uno cards. "Entrapta, you playing?"

Entrapta looked up from her computer, scanning the room. "I'll pass. Eleven people playing Uno seems like a bad idea."

"I still vote for karaoke!" Sea Hawk said with a flourish.

"And I told you if you bring your karaoke machine again, I'll throw it out a window," Catra reminded him darkly . Scorpia returned with snacks, and everyone settled in while Catra dealt the cards.

Glimmer leaned over to whisper to Bow. "Definitely Adora's type. But I think she's dating Perfuma?" It hadn't been specified, but Scorpia and Perfuma were definitely very cozy and casually intimate.

"Maybe," Bow whispered back. "Too bad."

Adora ignored them, picking up her cards and scanning them. She really hoped they dropped this by the end of the night.

Entrapta had the right idea to sit out; the game turned into chaos pretty fast. Mermista wasn't the *only* hyper competitive one — Catra threw cards down like they were weapons, Perfuma was surprisingly vindictive, Netossa seemed to enjoy riling other people up, and Glimmer refused to lose.

Mermista put down another draw four, and Sea Hawk whimpered. He had at least fifteen cards in his hands. "Red," Mermista declared. Bow looked nervously at his hand, then at Glimmer, then slowly put down what must have been the only red card he had — a draw two. Glimmer looked utterly betrayed.

"You're sleeping on the couch tonight."

"I *know*."

Adora put down a yellow draw two. Catra glared at her. "I'm taking your bike back," she informed her seriously as she picked up her cards. "I know where you live."

"You can have anything *but* the bike."

Catra raised an eyebrow, leaning around Adora. "How about Sparkles?"

"Um, no!" Glimmer protested. "Adora isn't trading *him* to save her bike, right Adora?" No answer. Adora just stared at her cards. "*Right, Adora?*"

Scorpia hesitantly put down a yellow four to continue the game.

They took a break after an hour, when it was obvious the game wouldn't be ending any time soon. Adora stood, relieved for a chance to stretch her aching muscles. She saw Catra slip outside, and carefully followed.

"You okay?"

"Huh? Oh, yeah." Catra sat on the stoop, drawing her legs up to her chest. "They just get kind of loud. Are *you* okay?"

"Yeah." Adora leaned against the house, hands behind her back. "Why wouldn't I be?"

"I know what someone in pain looks like." Catra shrugged, looking out to the street. "You've been readjusting your sitting position every three minutes."

Adora blinked, surprised. She hadn't noticed. "I have um. chronic pain stuff. Got hurt on deployment, and the military ditched me when they realized they couldn't use me anymore."

"Of fucking course," Catra said, rolling her eyes. "Netossa's a vet, and they basically did the same thing to her. She used to spend hours on the phone with the VA trying to get disability and all that straightened out. Sounds like a nightmare."

"I'm not really a fan." Adora usually tried not to sound too bitter — she knew she should just be grateful she'd made it back alive.

Asking for anything else was selfish. But was it really wrong to *want* more?

"Is that what the special bike is for?"

Adora shook herself out of her thoughts, looking back at Catra. "Yeah, it's a recumbent bike. I spent months researching bikes when I got back, and that was the best one."

"Now I'm even more pissed off at the guy who took it. Scorpia should've let me punch him again."

"I'm pretty sure that's assault."

"What was he gonna do, call the police?" Catra put on a fake, dumb-sounding voice. "Hello, nine-one-one? This lady punched me because I stole a disabled vet's specialty bike."

Adora snorted. "Fair. Honestly, it was kind of my own fault. I knew I should have moved it to the backyard."

"Your lock system could've been better, but don't let the asshole off the hook. Stealing is stealing, whether it was locked down or not."

Glimmer and Bow had said the exact same thing. But something about hearing it from Catra made Adora feel a little better. "Hey, Catra." Spinerella poked her head out the door. "Oh, Adora! We were wondering where you went. The game is starting."

"Oh, good." Catra stood, stretching. "I'm ready to kick Mermista's ass."

In the end, Spinerella was the one who walked away in victory. She went out first, ignoring her wife's claims of betrayal and Catra declaring that she was *definitely* not her mother. Bow was next, knowing full well he was at risk of sleeping on the couch. It stopped mattering as much once the third person—Perfuma—put her last

card down. At that point it turned into people just putting down the worst cards they could and declaring who suffered from it.

"I'm pretty sure that's not how the game works," Scorpia said as Mermista threw another draw four at Catra.

"Just let them play, lovebug."

The less competitive players started bowing out, leaving the vindictive ones to destroy themselves. Entrapta had stopped to observe the interactions, fascinated.

"Oooooooookay," Bow said, finally dragging Glimmer away from the cards. "It's a bit late. Time to go home, maybe."

"Byyyyyyyyye Sparkles," Catra sang, waving. Her last draw four stared teasingly up from the floor.

"I'll be back for you," Glimmer informed her, eyes narrowed.

"Thanks for inviting us!" Bow said quickly, waving as they left. Glimmer threw herself into the car, huffing and crossing her arms. Bow climbed into the driver's seat while Adora took up in the back. "I like them."

"Scorpia and Perfuma are definitely dating, though." Glimmer looked at Adora in the rearview mirror. "Tough luck, Adora."

"Yeah." Adora shrugged. "Tough luck."

This was fine, she decided. If they thought she liked Scorpia, then fine. She'd never got another moment of peace if they thought she liked Catra.

The thought brought a smile to her lips. She nestled into the backseat, watching the streetlights go by. She could live with this.

End Notes

SO BASICALLY Adora is my wife. I told her over and over to put the bike somewhere safe and that no, chaining it to a cinderblock was not enough, and she kept saying she was going to move it, and then one day POOF, bike gone. Le sigh.

Like. a month later? A woman knocks on our door and asks me about the bike, and I explain that it was stolen, and she WENT OFF saying she saw someone riding it down the street and she knew it was ours because she recognized it from our front yard (idk if you guys have ever seen a recumbent bike, but they stand out), and then she took off to find the guy. Unfortunately, we did NOT get the bike back, which we weren't expecting to honestly, but it was the most bizarre thing I'd experienced in awhile and of course my first thought was "this is such a Catradora thing."And now here we are lol.

(we still look out for the bike now that we know it's still in the neighborhood. Maybe someday.)

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